

THE AVERAGERS

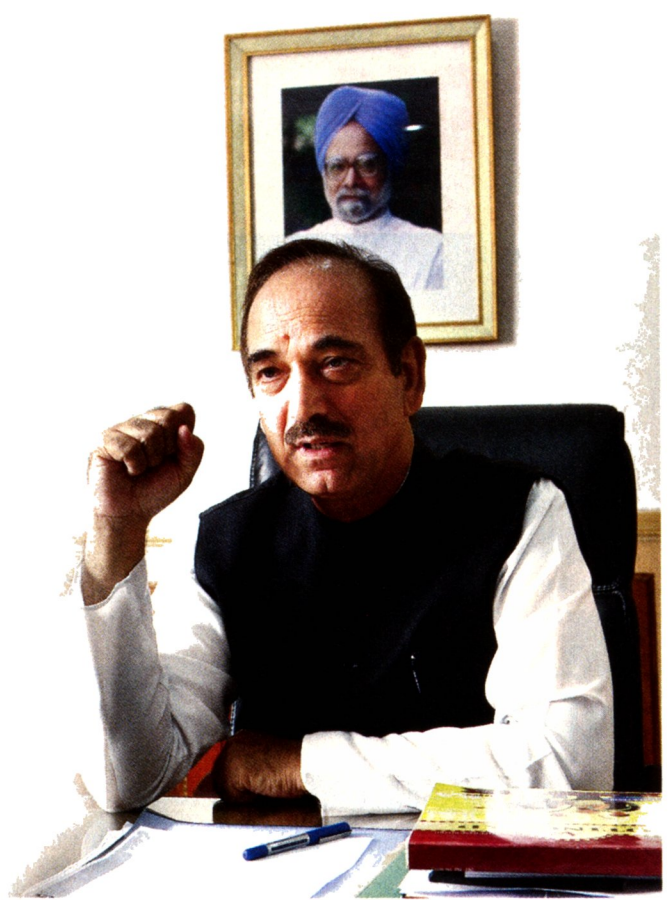


GHULAM NABI AZAD

• Health Minister

● **AGENDA** The one word that sums up Azad's agenda is manpower. From beefing up the National Rural Health Mission, supplying "specialist doctors" to rural India under the Health Manpower Policy to boosting seats in medical colleges—the minister is looking at human resources to battle health woes.

● **PERFORMANCE** The H1N1 flu outbreak forced the ministry to focus exclusively on pandemic preparations and a multi-layered plan was rolled out. But little has transpired on other fronts. Also managed to look silly by saying that couples watching more television would have fewer babies.



HEMANT CHAWLA

THE LAGGARDS



VEERAPPA MOILY

• Law Minister



SIPRA DAS

● **AGENDA** Judicial reforms are a priority agenda in the UPA's 100-day plan as is Manmohan's stress on the need for curbing corruption in the judiciary. Last fortnight, at a chief ministers' meet in New Delhi, he said that over three crore cases clog the arteries of the country's legal system—from the district courts all the way to the Supreme Court.

● **PERFORMANCE**

The Government was off the blocks early in the day when it tried to push the controversial Judges (Asset) Bill. Then, it suffered further embarrassment when Supreme Court judges decided to declare their assets. Moily is now busy preparing a road map to instil accountability in the judiciary.

SHEKHAR GHOSH



MURLI DEORA

• Petroleum Minister

● **AGENDA** The Government drove an ambitious agenda of providing fuel at reasonable prices and ensuring energy security. The 100-day plan included launching a new LPG scheme and strengthening oil PSUs. Deora also promised to extend CNG distribution.

● **PERFORMANCE** Deora has backed out of dismantling administered prices and there is no sign of cutting down on subsidies. The health of oil PSUs remains a cause for worry. In the battle between the Ambani brothers, he is clearly seen to be taking sides.